DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT REPORT

Course Code: CSE0001

Course Title: Digital Literacy

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Program: BTech CSE (AIML)

Introduction

This project is based on the concept of digital literacy, which plays an essential role in today's academic and professional environment. The aim of this project is to develop an understanding of digital tools, online communication, and safe internet practices.

Through this project, I explored different aspects of digital literacy including creating a professional online presence, using collaboration platforms, practicing coding, and understanding cyber security risks. Each task was designed to provide practical exposure to real-world digital skills.

This project helped me become more aware of how to use digital platforms responsibly and effectively.

Task 1 – Creating a Digital Literacy Infographic

For designing my Digital Literacy Awareness infographic, I used **Canva** as the primary tool due to its user-friendly interface and wide range of templates, icons, and customization features. Canva made it easy to create a visually appealing and well-structured infographic suitable for an academic project.

My design highlights the concept of digital literacy and its importance for students in today's technology-driven world. It includes key sections such as the definition of digital literacy, useful digital tools for students, internet safety practices, professional online presence, and email etiquette. Each section is presented using concise bullet points along with relevant icons to ensure clarity and visual engagement. The overall layout follows a clean and minimal design with a consistent colour theme to maintain professionalism.

One aspect I found particularly interesting was selecting and aligning appropriate icons that effectively represent each concept without overcrowding the design. However, it was somewhat challenging to keep the content brief while still covering all essential points. This task helped me understand the importance of combining creativity with clarity in digital communication.

Task 2 – Building a Student Digital Portfolio

For my digital portfolio, I selected GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle to build a strong and well-rounded professional presence.

GitHub is used to showcase my coding work, projects, and learning progress. I plan to regularly upload projects related to Python, Prolog, and Machine Learning, which will help demonstrate my technical skills and consistency.

LinkedIn serves as my professional identity, where I can present my academic background and connect with peers, seniors, and industry professionals. I will use it to share my achievements, certifications, and projects, and to explore internship and career opportunities.

Kaggle is a platform focused on data science and machine learning. I am using it to practice data analysis through notebooks and plan to participate in competitions to improve my analytical and problem-solving skills.

Over the next four years, I aim to actively maintain all three platforms, build meaningful projects, and continuously improve my skills, which will help me secure internships and future job opportunities.

Task 3 – Coding and Collaboration Platforms

I used HackerRank as a coding practice platform and Google Forms as a collaboration tool to complete this task. On HackerRank, I solved the beginner-level problem “Solve Me First,” which helped me understand basic input-output operations and strengthened my programming fundamentals. It also improved my confidence in writing simple and correct code.

For collaboration, I created a “Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz” using Google Forms. This allowed me to design questions, set correct answers, and automatically collect responses in Google Sheets. Through this, I learned how to gather and analyse data efficiently.

These platforms are highly beneficial for my academic growth. HackerRank will help me regularly practice coding, improve problem-solving skills, and prepare for technical assessments. Google Forms and Sheets will assist me in conducting surveys, organizing data, and working collaboratively on academic projects.

Overall, this task enhanced both my technical and practical skills, which will be useful for my studies and future career development.

Task 4 – Professional Email Writing and Etiquette

Email 1 – Assignment extension request

To:professor.kanan@vitbhopal.ac.in

Subject: Request for Extension – Digital Literacy Assignment

Dear Professor Kanan,

I hope you are doing well.

I am writing to request a short extension for the Digital Literacy assignment due on 30th March. I have been unwell recently, which affected my progress.

I would be grateful if you could allow me an additional two days to complete and submit the assignment properly.

Thank you for your consideration.

Regards,

Name-Tushar Chauhan

Reg No-25BAI11335

BTech CSE (AIML)

Email 2 – Internship Interest

To: careers@company.com

Subject: Inquiry Regarding Summer Internship Opportunity

Dear Hiring Manager,

I hope you are doing well.

I am Tushar Chauhan, a B.Tech Computer Science student at VIT Bhopal. I am writing to inquire about any available summer internship opportunities at your organization.

I have been developing my skills in Python and web development and have worked on projects available on my GitHub profile. I am keen to gain practical experience and contribute to real-world projects.

You can find my work and profile here:

GitHub: https://github.com/Tushar7902

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/tushar-chauhan01b80b34b/?skipRedirect=true

I would appreciate any information regarding internship openings or the application process.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Regards,

Tushar Chauhan

Email: tushar.25bai11335@vitbhopal.ac.in

Reflection on Digital Communication Etiquette

Poor digital communication can create confusion and leave a negative impression. For example, a student sending a message like "Sir pls extend deadline" without a subject, greeting, or proper explanation appears unprofessional and unclear. Such messages may be ignored or misunderstood by the receiver. This situation could have been handled better by writing a structured email with a clear subject line, polite greeting, and proper explanation of the issue. Including a respectful tone and complete information helps in conveying the message effectively. Good digital communication is important because it ensures clarity, avoids misunderstandings, and reflects professionalism. It also increases the chances of receiving a positive response and helps in building a strong academic and professional image.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness: Phishing Case Study

Introduction

In today's digital age, online transactions and communication have become an essential part of daily life, especially for students. However, with the increasing use of digital platforms, cybercrimes are also rising rapidly. Many of these crimes do not involve complex hacking but instead exploit human behaviour such as trust, urgency, and lack of awareness.

This project focuses on understanding a common cybercrime scenario and highlighting practical ways to stay safe online. The aim is to create awareness among students so that they can recognize threats and avoid becoming victims.

Case Study: UPI Payment Fraud

UPI payment fraud is one of the most common cybercrimes in India today. It involves tricking users into authorizing transactions themselves by manipulating their understanding of how digital payments work.

A typical case involves a student selling items online who is contacted by a buyer. The buyer appears genuine and offers to make an advance payment. Shortly after, the victim receives a payment request and is instructed to enter their UPI PIN to receive money. Due to excitement or lack of awareness, the victim follows the instructions.

However, entering the UPI PIN approves a payment, resulting in money being debited instead of credited. In many cases, scammers send multiple requests quickly, causing further loss before the victim realizes what is happening.

This type of fraud mainly targets students, new users of digital payment systems, and individuals who act quickly without verifying details. The consequences include financial loss, stress, and reduced trust in digital platforms.

Prevention Checklist (Stay Safe Online)

To avoid becoming a victim of cybercrime, especially UPI fraud, the following precautions should be followed:

- Always verify the identity of the sender before responding to any message or request.
- Never share passwords, OTPs, or banking details with anyone.
- Check website links carefully before entering personal information.
- Avoid clicking on unknown or suspicious links related to jobs or offers.
- Enable two-factor authentication (2FA) on important accounts.
- Use strong and unique passwords for different platforms.
- Never enter your UPI PIN to receive money — it is only used for sending money.
- Do not approve unknown UPI collect requests or scan QR codes from strangers.
- Regularly monitor your bank transactions for unusual activity.

Reporting Cybercrime:

- National Cyber Crime Portal: https://cybercrime.gov.in
- Helpline Number: 1930

Reflection

While researching this topic, I was surprised to learn that many cybercrimes do not require advanced technical skills. Instead, attackers take advantage of human behaviour such as urgency, trust, and lack of awareness. One of the most shocking realizations was that victims themselves unknowingly authorize transactions in UPI fraud cases.

This changed my perspective on cybersecurity completely. I now understand that being careful and aware is more important than just having technical knowledge.

As a result, one habit I will personally change is avoiding instant reactions to any financial request. I will always take time to verify the source before acting, especially in online transactions. This simple step can help prevent major losses and improve digital safety.

References

- Canva – canva.com (used for Task 1 infographic design)
- GitHub – github.com (used for Task 2 portfolio and project repository)
- LinkedIn – linkedin.com (used for Task 2 professional profile)
- Kaggle – kaggle.com (used for Task 2 data science portfolio)
- HackerRank – hackerrank.com (used for Task 3 coding practice)
- Google Forms – forms.google.com (used for Task 3 quiz)
- National Cyber Crime Portal – cybercrime.gov.in (referenced in Task 5)